THOMISTS

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THOMISTS, a feet of school-driven, who maintain thom- in, and the preceding article.
THEORACIC Dc ctr. See Astronomy, p. 282.

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ſhire, ſituated on the river Swale, ſixteen miles north-weſt of York. It ſends two members to parliament.

THIRST, an uneaſy ſenſation, ariſing from a deficiency in the ſaliva to moiſten the inward parts of the mouth; hence ariſes a ſtrong deſire for drink: it is a ſymptom generally attending feveriſh diſorders.

THISTLE, in botany. See CARDUUS.

Order of the THISTLE, *or of St* ANDREW, a military order of knighthood in Scotland, the riſe and inſtitution whereof is variouſly related by different authors. Lefley, biſhop of Roſs, reports, that the night before the battle between Athelſtan king of Northumberland, and Hungus king of the Picts, a bright croſs, in form of that whereon St Andrew (the tutelar ſaint of Scotland) ſuffered martyrdom, appeared to Hungus; who having gained the victory, ever after bore the figure of that croſs on his banners. Others aſſert, that Achaius king of Scotland firſt inſtituted this order, after having made the famous league offenſive and defenſive with Charlemagne king of France. But although the thiſtle had been acknowledged as the ſymbol of the kingdom of Scotland from the reign of Achaius, yet ſome refer the beginning of this order to Charles VII. of France. Others place the foundation of it as low as the year 1500.

The chief and principal enſign is a gold collar compoſed of thiſtles and ſprigs of rue interlinked with amulets of gold, having pendent thereunto the image of St Andrew with his croſs, and the motto, NEMO ME IMPUNE LACESSET.

The ordinary or common enſign worn by the knights, is a ſtar of four ſilver points, and over them a green circle, bordered and lettered with gold, containing the ſaid motto, and in the centre is a thiſtle proper; all which is embroidered on their left breaſt, and worn with the collar, with a green ribband over the left ſhoulder, and brought under the right arm; pendent thereto is the image of St Andrew, with his croſs, in a purple robe, within an oval of gold enamelled vert, with the former motto: but ſometimes they wear, encircled in the ſame manner, a thiſtle crowned.

About the time of the reformation, this order was dropped, till James II. of England reſumed it, by creating eight knights: however, the revolution unſettled it again, and it lay neglected till queen Anne, in 1703, reſtored it to the primitive deſign, of twelve knights of St Andrew.

THLASPI, in botany, a genus of the tetradynamia ſiliculoſa claſs. The pod is emarginated, heart-ſhaped, containing many ſeeds. There are ten ſpecies, ſix of them natives of Britain, *viz.* the campeſtre, or mithridate; the arvenſe, or treacle-muſtard; the perfoliatum, or perfoliate treacle-muſtard; the furtum, or perennial mithridate muſtard; the montanum, or mountain mithridate-muſtard; and the burſa paſtoris, or ſhepherd's purſe.

THOMÆANS, THOMISTS, or *Chriſtians of St* THOMAS, a people of the Eaſt-Indies, who, according to the tradition, received the Goſpel from St Thomas. Upon the arrival of the Portugueſe at Calicut, in their firſt voyage to the Indies, they met with ancient Chriſtians, who pretended to be deſcended from thoſe converted by St Thomas. The Thomæans being informed of a new people arrived among them, who bore a particular veneration for the croſs, ſent embaſſadors to them, to make an alliance with them, and to ſollicit their aſſiſtance againſt the Gentile princes, by whom they were greatly oppreſſed. A mixture of opinions, with a total interruption of paſtors, ſometimes for ſeveral years together, occaſioned that horrible chaos their religion was in at the arrival of the Portugueſe; for a ſpecimen whereof we ſhall add their manner of celebrating the euchariſt: Over their altar was a kind of gallery; and while the prieſt was ſaying the beginning of the office below, a cake of flour of rice was frying in oil, or butter, above; when enough, the cake was let down in a baſket upon the altar, where the prieſt conſecrated it: as to the other ſpecies, for wine they uſed a kind of brandy or arrack, variouſly prepared in that country. Nor was their ordination much more regular; the archdeacon, who was ſometimes more reſpected than the biſhop himſelf, frequently ordained prieſts: their other abuſes were infinite. The Portugueſe, for theſe two laſt centuries, have laboured the reformation of this church, and have employed both the eccleſiaſtic and ſecular power therein: for this end they have called the Thomæan biſhops to the council at Goa, have inſtructed, charged them, *&c.* and even ſent them for inſtruction to Portugal and Rome; but finding that they were ſtill apt to relapſe at their return, and that no good was like to be done with them, they reſolved to exclude them once for all, and to appoint an European biſhop in their room. Theſe proceedings have rendered the Portugueſe infinitely odious to the Thomæans.

St THOMAS, a city of the hither India, on the coaſt of Coromandel, three miles ſouth of Fort St George; ſubject to the Portugueſe.

St THOMAS is alſo an iſland in the Atlantic ocean, ſituated under the equator, in 8° E. long.

St THOMAS is alſo a town of Guiana, in South America, ſituated on the river Oronoko; ſubject to Spain.

St. THOMAS's DAY, a feſtival of the Chriſtian church, obſerved on Dec. 21. in commemoration of St Thomas the apoſtle.

St THOMAS *of Canterbury's day*, a feſtival of the Romiſh church, obſerved on Dec. 29. in memory of Thomas Becket archbiſhop of Canterbury, who was murdered, or, as the Romaniſts ſay, martyred, in the reign of king Henry II.

THOMISM, the doctrine of St Thomas Aquinas, and his followers the Thomiſts, chiefly with regard to predeſtination and grace. There is ſome doubt what the true genuine thomiſm is, but there are authors who diſtinguiſh the thomiſm of St Thomas from that of the dominicans. Others again make thomiſm no other than a kind of janſeniſm diſguiſed: but janſeniſm, it is known, has been condemned by the popes, which pure thomiſm never was: in effect, the writings of Alvarez and Lemos, who were appointed by their order to lay down and defend, before the holy ſee, the dogmata of their ſchool, have ſince been reputed the rule of pure thomiſm.

THOMISTS, a ſect of ſchool-divines, who maintain thomiſm. See the preceding article.

THORACIC DUCT. See ANATOMY, p. 282.

THORAX, in anatomy. See ANATOMY, p. 277.

THORN, a city of Poland, in the province of regal Pruſſia, ſituated on the river Viſtula: E. long. 19°, and N. lat. 52° 40'.

THORN-

Figure 1: *
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